

UNITED KINGDOM

United Kingdom – Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
Short Form	United Kingdom (UK)
Capital	London
Region (UN)	Western Europe
Government Type	Unitary parliamentary constitutional monarchy
Head of State	King Charles III
Head of Government	Prime Minister Keir Starmer (since 5 July 2024)
Currency	Pound Sterling (GBP)
UN Member Since	24 October 1945 (Founding Member)
MUN Standing	Permanent member of the UN Security Council (P5); influential in global diplomacy, peacekeeping, and international development.

Recommended Books on UK Foreign Policy and UN Engagement

Title	Author(s)	Relevance
<i>Britain and the United Nations</i>	Stephen Ryan	Explores the UK's historical and contemporary role within the UN framework.
<i>The Foreign Policy of the United Kingdom</i>	Jamie Gaskarth	Analyzes the UK's foreign policy decisions and their global implications.
<i>Global Britain in a Competitive Age: The Integrated Review of Security, Defence, Development and Foreign Policy</i>	UK Government	Official document outlining the UK's strategic vision post-Brexit.
<i>The United Kingdom and the United Nations: A Policy Paper</i>	Chatham House	Provides insights into the UK's priorities and challenges within the UN.
<i>The United Nations Security Council and the Politics of International Authority</i>	Bruce Cronin & Ian Hurd	Discusses the dynamics of authority within the UNSC, with

references to the UK.

Research Table: UK & the UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UN Web TV – UK at UNSC	https://webtv.un.org/	Search for UK statements in Security Council debates.
Chatham House – UK and the UNSC	https://www.chathamhouse.org/topics/united-nations	In-depth policy analysis on the UK's influence in UNSC decisions.
British Foreign Policy Group – UNSC Policy	https://bfpg.co.uk/	Reports and commentary on how UK foreign policy is applied at the UN.
UN Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs (UK Role)	https://dppa.un.org/en	Insights into UK peace operations and mediation support.
RUSI – UK Role in Conflict Resolution	https://rusi.org/	Strategic briefings related to UK's UNSC interests.
International Crisis Group – UK and Global Conflict	https://www.crisisgroup.org/	Independent analysis of UK diplomacy in Security Council crises.
SIPRI – UK Arms Policy and Peacekeeping	https://www.sipri.org	Statistics and analysis on UK's global defense contributions.
King's College London – UK in International Law & Security	https://www.kcl.ac.uk/sspp/policy-institute	Academic resources on UK's use of international legal frameworks.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – UK Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/united-kingdom-great-britain-and-northern-ireland (climaterights.org, ohchr.org)	Official overview of treaty ratifications, OHCHR visits, and monitoring activities—a key UN baseline.

OHCHR – UK UPR Index & Docs	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ua-index	Full archive of UPR national reports, stakeholder inputs, and recommendations.
HRW – UPR Submission (Mar 2022)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/03/31/submission-universal-periodic-review-united-kingdom-great-britain-and-northern	Highlights issues like Chagos Islanders, rights act repeal, impacting rule-of-law reviews.
Amnesty – UPR Submission 2022 (PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/documents/eur45/5421/2022/en/	Evaluates UPR progress and rights implementation in civil liberties and asylum law.
UN WebTV – UPR Adoption (41st Sess)	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1o/k1o87c2h9h	Live recording of UK's UPR adoption dialogue —real-time insight into stakeholder engagement.
US State Dept – 2023 HR Report	https://www.state.gov/reports/2023-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/united-kingdom/	Official overview of UK's civil-political, detention, refugee, and gender rights landscape.
OHCHR – Special Procedures Visits	https://spinternet.ohchr.org/ViewCountryVisits.aspx?Lang=en&country=GBR&visitType=all	Lists UN special mandate-holders' visits (e.g. freedom of expression, racism) — evidence of UN scrutiny.
HRW – UPR Update Oct 2022	https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/11/03/upr-update-october-2022-united-kingdom-0	Details post-UPR legislation (e.g. Bill of Rights

		proposal) relevant to UNHRC rule-of-law agenda.
Amnesty – Submission 2017 (PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/documents/eur45/5488/2017/en/	Early critical observations on extraterritorial obligations and human rights protections.
UN WebTV – UPR Adoption (2012)	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1u/k1u2xu312l	Historic UPR adoption, helping trace UK's rights evolution.
GOV.UK – Equality & Human Rights Monitor 2023	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/equality-and-human-rights-monitor-2023	Statutory report from EHRC tracking rights and equality metrics over five years.
US State Dept – 2022 HR Report	https://www.state.gov/reports/2022-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/united-kingdom/	Highlights asylum, enforcement, and policing issues via latest US review.
Amnesty – Torture-Briefing PDF	https://www.amnesty.org/en/wp-content/uploads/2021/06/eur450022013en.pdf	Briefing to UN Committee Against Torture—explores detention and torture standards.
GOV.UK – Human Rights & Democracy Reports	https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/human-rights-and-democracy-reports	Annual FCDO summaries of UK's global rights promotion and domestic issues.
US Embassy PDF – 2023 HR Report	https://uk.usembassy.gov/wp-content/uploads/sites/204/2024/12/UNITED-KINGDOM-2023-HUMAN-RIGHTS-REPORT.pdf	Reinforces State Dept findings on migration law and asylum rights.
Amnesty – Bill of Rights Critique PDF	https://www.amnesty.org/es/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/EUR4565812023ENGLISH.pdf	Statement critical of proposed Bill's erosion of ECHR protections.

HRW – World Report 2023 UK	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2023/country-chapters/united-kingdom	Documents new protest restrictions, asylum changes, racial inequality.
HRW – World Report 2024 UK	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/united-kingdom	Continues critique on protest laws, Rwanda plan, and civil rights.
HRW – UK HRC Spotlight (Nov 2022)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/11/08/uks-rights-record-under-global-spotlight-un	Covers UPR debates on migration, racism, austerity impacts.
Amnesty – Dissecting Rights Framework (2022 PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/ar/wp-content/uploads/2022/06/EUR4554212022ENGLISH.pdf	Analyzes weakening trend in UK's human rights protection post-2022.
UN WebTV – UPR Adoption (43rd Mtg)	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1r/k1rjfyshfn	Shows UK's 43rd adoption—highlighting follow-up and accountability.
ReliefWeb – Rights Erosion 2023	https://reliefweb.int/report/united-kingdom-great-britain-and-northern-ireland/uk-government-severely-eroded-human-rights-2023	UN-backed analysis of recent draconian legislation.
Freedom House – Country Profile	https://freedomhouse.org/country/united-kingdom/freedom-world/2023	Independent scores on political rights, civil liberties, and digital freedom.
OHCHR – SR on Extreme Poverty Visit	https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/3806308?ln=en	UN expert visit focusing on poverty-related rights—ties socioeconomic agenda.
ClimateRights – UK Report	https://climaterights.org/database/united-kingdom/	Tracks UK's compliance with right-to-healthy-

		environment standards.
HRW – UK Rights Record 2024 Brief	https://www.hrw.org/news/2024/01/11/uk-government-severely-eroded-human-rights-2023	Focuses on protest, migration laws, and asylum infringements.
OHCHR – UPR Process Overview	https://www.state.gov/universal-periodic-review-process/	External primer on UPR methodology and Council expectations.
Amnesty – Torture Briefing (2013 PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/es/wp-content/uploads/2021/06/eur450022013en.pdf	Earlier UNCAT commentary still relevant under torture monitoring.

10 Unique Aspects: UK & the UNHRC

1. **Undermining the Human Rights Act:** The plans to repeal the Human Rights Act and withdraw from the European Convention on Human Rights, which have been highlighted by Human Rights Watch and Amnesty International, have become a major concern for the Human Rights Committee regarding the rule of law.
2. **Asylum Seeker Expulsions:** The Rwanda plan and the Illegal Migration Act are under significant scrutiny from the Human Rights Council for potentially violating UN refugee obligations.
3. **Criminalizing Peaceful Protest:** The reforms to the Public Order Act have drawn international backlash for limiting the right to peaceful assembly—this is definitely a red flag for the Human Rights Council.
4. **Surveillance and Digital Rights:** The Online Safety Act is facing criticism from the UN for its potential to restrict free speech and privacy rights.
5. **Chagos Islanders Justice:** NGO submissions highlight the UK's refusal to let displaced islanders return, sparking discussions about colonial justice.
6. **Economic Disparities & Poverty:** The OHCHR's visits that focus on poverty highlight how socioeconomic rights are becoming a key theme for the Council's attention.
7. **Climate Rights Integration:** UK's human-rights-based environmental obligations are mapped via ClimateRights.org—linking climate and rights in Council reviews.
8. **Persistent International Promoter:** Even with some setbacks at home, the UK is still standing up for human rights on the global stage—a balancing act that's been closely

examined in HRC reports.

9. **A-Status NHRI Engagement:** The EHRC's "A" accreditation allows for strong participation in UPR submissions and engagement with the Council—it's a model of best practices from the UNHRC.
 10. **Bi-annual UPR Monitoring and Debate:** Active adoption sessions and follow-up reviews show that there's a lively interaction happening with the UN system.
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